

Devin Bissky Dziadyk

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Citizenship: Canadian

Areas of Research: Economic History, Urban Economics, Economic Geography

EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Ph.D. in Economics

Toronto, ON

Sep. 2020 – Present

- Committee: Stephan Heblich (Supervisor), Shari Eli, Tianyi Wang.

University of Toronto

M.A. in Economics

Toronto, ON

Sep. 2019 – May 2020

McGill University

B.Sc. in Physics & Economics

Montreal, QC

Sep. 2011 – May 2015

RESEARCH

Little School on the Prairie: A Push for Structural Transformation (JMP) Parcel Assembly

with Stephan Heblich and James Macek

Draft Complete

In Progress

Bridging the 49th Parallel: Matching Histories across the US-Canadian Border

with Kevin Didi, Shari Eli and Stephan Heblich

In Progress

Toronto vs Everybody: The Effect of Property Taxes on Business Establishments

Draft Complete

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

University of Toronto

Research Assistant for Stephan Heblich

Toronto, ON

Apr. 2021 – Dec. 2023

- Projects related to economic history, industrialization, and the slave trade in the United Kingdom.

Research Assistant for Professor Michael Smart

Apr. 2020 – Sep. 2020

- Developed the first version of Finances of the Nation [🔗](#).

University of Toronto

Teaching Assistant

Toronto, ON

Sep. 2019 – Present

- Macroeconomics (introductory, intermediate, and advanced), Data Analysis for Policy, Urban Economics, Managerial Economics.
- Taught over 350 hours across undergraduate courses, including derivations, coding, math, and paper discussions.
- Graded thousands of exams, 1-20 page essays, technical reports, and Harvard Business School cases.
- Hosted hundreds of hours of one-on-one office hours.

TrendMD

Account Manager

Toronto, ON

Nov. 2015 – Aug. 2019

- First employee at Y Combinator backed startup, created processes for issue tracking, client reporting, and pricing.
- Collaborated daily with CEO in Toronto, CTO in SF, QA in Macedonia, Sales in London, NYC, and Beijing.
- Managed an Account Manager team of four, including interviewing, hiring, onboarding, and offboarding.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Planche, Thomas, Gabriela Arias, Richard Baartman, Devin Bissky Dziadyk, Shane Koscielniak, Theresa LeRoss, Kevin Multani, and Thomas Zuiderveen. “Demagnetization of an Entire Accelerator Vault”. In: 7th Int. Particle Accelerator Conf. (IPAC’16), Busan, Korea, May 8-13, 2016. JACOW, Geneva, Switzerland, June 2016, pp. 4143–4145. ISBN: 978-3-95450-147-2. DOI: 10.18429/JACoW-IPAC2016-THPOY024.

Kudlow, Paul, Matthew Cockerill, Danielle Toccalino, Devin Bissky Dziadyk, Alan Rutledge, Aviv Shachak, Roger S. McIntyre, Arun Ravindran, and Gunther Eysenbach. “Online Distribution Channel Increases Article Usage on Mendeley: A Randomized Controlled Trial”. In: *Scientometrics* 112.3 (Sept. 1, 2017), pp. 1537–1556. ISSN: 1588-2861. DOI: 10.1007/s11192-017-2438-3.

Kudlow, Paul, Devin Bissky Dziadyk, Alan Rutledge, Aviv Shachak, and Gunther Eysenbach. “The Citation Advantage of Promoted Articles in a Cross-Publisher Distribution Platform: A 12-Month Randomized Controlled Trial”. In: *Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology* 71.10 (2020), pp. 1257–1274. ISSN: 2330-1643. DOI: 10.1002/asi.24330.

OTHER ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Awards

- Ontario Graduate Scholarship, 2025-2026, \$10,000
- Doctoral Award, SSHRC, 2023 - 2025, \$60,000
- Graduate Fellowship, Institute on Municipal Finance and Governance, 2022, \$5,000
- Graduate Fellowship, University of Toronto, 2020-2025, \$15,000 $\times$ 5
- Mitacs Accelerate, Mitacs Canada, 2020, \$10,000
- Faculty of Arts and Science Graduate Admission Award, University of Toronto, 2019, \$5,000

Refereeing

- Journal of Urban Economics $\times$ 2, Canadian Journal of Economics

Conference Presentations

- Canadian Network for Economic History (2025), Canadian Economic Association (2025), NBER Summer Institute (2025), IPUMS Data-Intensive Research Conference (2025), Economic History Association Meeting (2025)

Service

- Graduate Advisory Committee (Member), CUPE 3902 (Economics Steward), Department of Economics Run Club (Organizer), Graduate Economics Union (MA Representative, GEU Representative)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R (tidyverse, data.table), Python, L^AT_EX, STATA, HTML & CSS, MATLAB.

Languages: English (Native), French (A1).

REFERENCES

Stephan Heblich

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Little School on the Prairie: A Push for Structural Transformation

(Job Market Paper)

The one room school looms large in North American history, but we have little information on the role these rural schools played in economic development. Using linked full count census records from the early 20th century Canadian prairies combined with precise geolocations for individual households and schools, I examine the effect of the roll out of one room schools on children's education participation and later life outcomes. I find that geographic proximity plays an important roll in education participation, and educational participation correlates with adult income and decreases the likelihood of working in agriculture. Expanding to a difference in differences strategy exploiting the timing of school rollout, I find that a treated child who had a school constructed nearby is less likely to in agriculture as an adult, lives further from their childhood home, and has higher income. They are significantly more likely to work in a high skill services occupation, including as teachers, as adults. This suggests that education access can act as a push factor for structural transformation out of agriculture in rural areas.

Parcel Assembly

with Stephan Heblich and James Macek

Housing supply elasticities are significantly smaller in more developed areas. This paper explores a micro-foundation for this observation: that areas with more fragmented land are subject to a hold-up problem between landowners and developers. Using exogenous variation in parcel fragmentation from the nineteenth century in the city of Toronto, we show that areas with more parcels were less likely to be redeveloped in the twentieth century as the city grew.

Bridging the 49th Parallel: Matching Histories Across the US-Canadian Border

with Kevin Didi, Shari Eli and Stephan Heblich

Alexander Graham Bell was born in Scotland, emigrated to Canada following a family tragedy, and soon moved to the United States in search of better opportunities for his work teaching the deaf. His work eventually led to the invention of the telephone. By linking individual census records between Canada and the U.S. from this transformative period, we aim to uncover personal histories like that of Alexander Graham Bell while systematically documenting how cross-border migration flows shaped socioeconomic development on both sides of the border. This analysis will provide deeper insights into how migration influenced labor markets, industrial growth, and agricultural expansion in two nations that emerged as key players in the global economy during this time.

Toronto vs Everybody: The Effect of Property Taxes on Business Establishments

Business property taxes are a significant revenue source for municipalities, but what is their impact on local business establishments? Utilizing a change in provincial policy which forced the city of Toronto to lower business property tax rates, I examine the effect of business property taxes on business activity. I estimate that the elasticity of establishment employment with respect to the property tax rate is less than one, although the results are imprecise. I find larger elasticities for establishments utilizing industrial property versus commercial property, suggesting that industrial establishments are more sensitive to business property taxes. Contrasting with the previous literature I conclude that the impact on establishments from business property taxes can be minimized by maintaining updated property assessments and excluding fixed capital from the property assessment base.